YASHODA SUPER SPECIALITY HOSPITALS:

AN ASSURANCE OF ADVANCE & WORLD CLASS PATIENT CARE

Identified with super speciality treatment, complex surgeries, international expertise and state of art infrastructure, Yashoda Super Speciality Hospitals are one of the noted health care service providers in Delhi NCR. In this interview, its director, UPASANA ARORA, addresses a wide range of topics, from the journey of the group to the threat posed by the Omicron variant.

How would you sum up the journey so far of the Yashoda Group?

We commenced our operations with a 100 bed hospital. The hospital group is named after my mother in law, Yashoda, who died of cancer. My husband resolved that he wouldn't let others undergo the sufferings that our family had to endure. We started the hospital in 1990 on her name. We have a strong emotional connection with the hospital because we started it from scratch.

We kept adding new facilities as and when the need for them arose. Take the example of the blood bank. When we did not have a blood bank in the hospital, people would have to rush to Delhi for it. And considering the importance of time in such cases, we took a call to establish a blood bank at our hospital itself. Similarly, we added cath labs facilities for cardiac patients. Our emphasis is always on ensuring the safety of our patients. For us it is of paramount importance that they leave the hospital, fully satisfied.

What are the specialities offered by you?

We take a lot of pride in our super specialities. When the COVID19 pandemic struck, the importance of pulmonology got underlined. Particularly during the second wave, more & more patients turned up with various lung issues. At our hospital though we were already equipped with all the facilities related to pulmonology, be it ebus or thoracoscopy. We had the assurance of a good team of doctors & nursing staff. And that's why we could save a lot of lives even during the deadly second wave. Our cardiology department too is pretty renowned. In fact it is our patients who try to ensure that our hospital and its doctors receive their due recognition. They are our best brand ambassadors.

How would you reflect on the second wave of the COVID19 pandemic in India considering the enormous pressure it placed on the healthcare infrastructure?

That was a really tough phase. Emotionally, everybody had gotten exhausted. We did manage to save a lot of lives. But still there were some who didn't survive. And each of those losses strongly affected us. For a while, when there were no beds available, we placed our patients on chairs & trolleys. Our emphasis was on providing them oxygen and other modes of treatment. Then all we could think of was, somehow saving more and more patients. Some of the patients though unfortunately didn't even make it inside the hospital, they passed away in their vehicles on their way to us. And that was extremely painful. I pray everyday that we don't get to see that phase again.

With the Omicron variant fast spreading, how would you assess your preparedness?

The second wave of the COVID19 pandemic has left us all scarred. And hence there is a sense of fear accompanying omicron as well. It is a very infectious variant as one person can infect up to 18 people. Though the initial study suggests that it isn't as deadly as the delta variant. In South Africa it has been observed that the need for hospitalization is restricted to very few cases and most people are staging a reasonably quick recovery at home.

Plus, India has done a great job with its vaccination drives. So that does contribute in reducing the risk of the cases becoming severe. At our hospital, having tackled the second wave, we are now prepared to deal with whatever the omicron brings with itself. So be it mentally, or on the facilities front, we are all equipped.

Please elaborate on what the Medicity project entails!

It is being constructed in Indirapuram. The concept is of multiple hospitals within a huge hospital. So suppose a patient has neurological issues, the person then needs to simply head to the neurological wing. The patient needn't wander around with the prescription to see the doctor or get tests done.

We would offer all super specialized facilities, be it heart transplant, kidney transplant, liver transplant or lung transplant. It would also provide the various treatment procedures for cancer. The focus is on providing dedicated segments to each of the specialized requirements.

Our plan is to get started within 2 years.

IN CONVERSATION WITH

UPASANA ARORA
Director

